

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 17, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 41:1–26

1 Then he brought me into the sanctuary and measured the doorposts, six cubits wide on one side and six cubits wide on the other side—the width of the tabernacle.

2 The width of the entryway was ten cubits, and the side walls of the entrance were five cubits on this side and five cubits on the other side; and he measured its length, forty cubits, and its width, twenty cubits.

3 Also he went inside and measured the doorposts, two cubits; and the entrance, six cubits high; and the width of the entrance, seven cubits.

4 He measured the length, twenty cubits; and the width, twenty cubits, beyond the sanctuary; and he said to me, "This is the Most Holy Place."

5 Next, he measured the wall of the temple, six cubits. The width of each side chamber all around the temple was four cubits on every side.

6 The side chambers were in three stories, one above the other, thirty chambers in each story; they rested on ledges which were for the side chambers all around, that they might be supported, but not fastened to the wall of the temple.

7 As one went up from story to story, the side chambers became wider all around, because their supporting ledges in the wall of the temple ascended like steps; therefore the width of the structure increased as one went up from the lowest story to the highest by way of the middle one.

8 I also saw an elevation all around the temple; it was the foundation of the side chambers, a full rod, that is, six cubits high.

9 The thickness of the outer wall of the side chambers was five cubits, and so also the remaining terrace by the place of the side chambers of the temple.

10 And between it and the wall chambers was a width of twenty cubits all around the temple on every side.

11 The doors of the side chambers opened on the terrace, one door toward the north and another toward the south; and the width of the terrace was five cubits all around.

12 The building that faced the separating courtyard at its western end was seventy cubits wide; the wall of the building was five cubits thick all around, and its length ninety cubits.

13 So he measured the temple, one hundred cubits long; and the separating courtyard with the building and its walls was one hundred cubits long;

14 also the width of the eastern face of the temple, including the separating courtyard, was one hundred cubits.

15 He measured the length of the building behind it, facing the separating courtyard, with its galleries on the one side and on the other side, one hundred cubits, as well as the inner temple and the porches of the court,

16 their doorposts and the beveled window frames. And the galleries all around their three stories opposite the threshold were paneled with wood from the ground to the windows—the windows were covered—

17 from the space above the door, even to the inner room, as well as outside, and on every wall all around, inside and outside, by measure.

18 And it was made with cherubim and palm trees, a palm tree between cherub and cherub. Each cherub had two faces,

19 so that the face of a man was toward a palm tree on one side, and the face of a young lion toward a palm tree on the other side; thus it was made throughout the temple all around.

20 From the floor to the space above the door, and on the wall of the sanctuary, cherubim and palm trees were carved.

21 The doorposts of the temple were square, as was the front of the sanctuary; their appearance was similar.

22 The altar was of wood, three cubits high, and its length two cubits. Its corners, its length, and its sides were of wood; and he said to me, "This is the table that is before the Lord."

23 The temple and the sanctuary had two doors.

24 The doors had two panels apiece, two folding panels: two panels for one door and two panels for the other door.

25 Cherubim and palm trees were carved on the doors of the temple just as they were carved on the walls. A wooden canopy was on the front of the vestibule outside.

26 There were beveled window frames and palm trees on one side and on the other, on the sides of the vestibule—also on the side chambers of the temple and on the canopies.

II. Key Summary

- The guide brought Ezekiel into the sanctuary and measured it—forty cubits long and twenty cubits wide; then he went inside alone, measured a room twenty cubits square, and told Ezekiel, "This is the Most Holy Place" (vv. 1–4).
 - Three stories of side chambers were built all around the temple, thirty chambers in each story, growing wider the higher they went; their beams rested on ledges in the wall rather than being fastened into the temple wall itself (vv. 5–11).
 - Inside, every wall was paneled with wood from the floor to above the door, and cherubim and palm trees were carved on the walls and on the doors, a palm tree between every two cherubim; a wooden altar also stood there, and the guide said to Ezekiel, "This is the table that is before the Lord" (vv. 16–22).
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III. Passage Analysis

The Farther In You Go, the Narrower the Door

The temple Ezekiel saw, like Solomon's temple, was divided into three parts: the vestibule, the holy place, and the Most Holy Place. Note especially that the entrances to the vestibule, the holy place, and the Most Holy Place were fourteen cubits, ten cubits, and six cubits wide. The entrances grow progressively smaller, symbolizing that the holiness of the temple keeps rising. [1]

This chapter just keeps reporting numbers, but there's a pattern hidden inside them: the closer you get to where God is, the smaller the doorway. God isn't shutting people out—He's letting them know that going farther in is something you have to take seriously.

There's a Table at the Very Center

It is called a table, as being that at which the Lord will take delight in His people, as at a feast. [2]

After passing through doors that got narrower one by one, what Ezekiel saw at the very center was "the table that is before the LORD" (some commentators link its meaning to the showbread table in the holy place; see Exodus 25:30; Leviticus 24:5–9 [1]). God draws the lines that clearly and that strictly, and at the very center He sets a table. A table is for a feast—that is where the Lord takes delight in His people.

IV. Reflection Question

Do you think the boundaries God gives you are there to keep you out, or to bring you in?

Ezekiel kept walking inward, and every door was narrower than the last—but what waited for him at the very center was a table the Lord Himself had set.

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Website, Bible Intensive Reading Commentary — Notes on Ezekiel 41, <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT41.htm>

[2] BibleHub.com, Jamieson-Fausset-Brown Bible Commentary (Ezekiel 41:22), <https://biblehub.com/commentaries/ezekiel/41-22.htm>